My Stress Signature

Level 1 · Reset and Mental Calibration

Name _____ Date _____

Everyone has a stress signature: the particular way stress first shows up in their body, thoughts, and behaviour. For some it is a tight jaw. For others it is a racing mind at 3am, snapping at someone they love, or reaching for the phone. Most people only notice stress when it is already loud. When you know your signature, you can catch it early, while a short reset is still enough.

The earlier you notice stress, the less it takes to reset.

PART 1 Your Early Signals

Notice where stress shows up first. Be as specific as you can.

In your body

Jaw, shoulders, stomach, breathing, heart rate, sleep, appetite.

In your thoughts

Racing, catastrophising, going blank, replaying conversations.

In your behaviour

Over-working, avoiding, snacking, scrolling, snapping, withdrawing.

PART 2 Your Triggers

Stress is usually set off by the same few situations. Name yours.

Trigger 1

THE SITUATION

MY FIRST SIGNAL

Trigger 2

THE SITUATION

MY FIRST SIGNAL

Trigger 3

THE SITUATION

MY FIRST SIGNAL

PART 3 Your Resets

Match a short reset to each level of stress, so you always know what to do.

When you notice the first signal (60 seconds)

For example: three slow breaths, longer out than in. Drop your shoulders. Name what you are feeling.

When stress is building (5 minutes)

For example: a short walk, The Fast Reset, a glass of water away from the screen.

When you are overwhelmed (30 minutes or more)

For example: a Meditation Garden audio, exercise, a call with someone who steadies you.

YOUR SIGNATURE IN ONE SENTENCE

When I notice …

The earlier you notice stress, the less it takes to reset.